

Photograph by MANDAR DEODHAR

VANIITHA JAIIN, 44
Founder, Revelry Distillery & Vanaha Gin
Mumbai

ing on a "forest-to-bottle" concept, she created a five-step distillation process that included a vapour infusion chamber and cold vacuum distillation to treat over 200 delicate botanicals like flowers and herbs before distilling them down to a final 24 after over 7,000 hours of R&D. The zero-sugar Vahana, which has won 16 global awards since launch, is available in seven Indian states.

Headquartered in Mumbai, Revelry Distillery currently has a staff of 24 and the capacity to produce about a million bottles a year. Together with husband Navvin Jaiin, a former banking and insurance professional, the couple has infused a corporate flavour in their systems and processes to build a "house of premium spirits". Vaniitha's journey is proof that "India can make great spirits, a gin that is world-class and represent that the best can be made from India". Going forward, expect more products under the Vanaha brand. Work has left Vaniitha with no time for her passion for endurance sports—she has trained for Ironman and used to run marathons. "For now, entrepreneurship's the longest endurance event I've ever taken up," she says. ■

— M.G. Arun